TA brief · access, kit and safety

Prepare a small toy, rough and smooth paper, start line, ruler, low clear track, torch and marked ball, warming-chain cards and record sheets. The toy table has two runs on each surface. A demonstration, supplied model or pointing route is valid.

Check the school risk assessment and current local science guidance. A moving toy may fall or hit someone. Use a low clear track and keep hands and faces away. Keep kit at desk height and torch light out of eyes. Keep the toy, start and launch method the same; one uncontrolled run cannot establish a cause.

The pair works with a shared model and individual evidence. One explains and one asks for the clue, then they swap. Hear both independent reasons before moving on. Re-model an unsure learner's step and use a fresh parallel question while the other continues.

No cold calling or forced public reading. A learner may pass. Point, sign, speak, draw, type, write, direct an adult or use exact scribing. Read the task exactly when needed. Keep the science challenge and allow planning in any language. EAL is language, not SEN.

Use the least prompt needed, then fade it. Keep prompts separate from the pupil's response.

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TA brief · prompt ladder and stage handover

1. Point to the relevant place / instruction.

2. Ask one short question: "What is it asking you to find?"

3. Rephrase the instruction in simpler language.

4. Provide a scaffold or limited choice.

5. Model the first step only, then return the task to the pupil.

Arrival: predictable start and private choice. Starter: hear first attempts before answers. I do: point to the model and let the learner track each step. We do: leave the missing step to the learner. Independent: protect an individual first try.

Review and Exit: the adult receives the learner’s own science, names it back and agrees a precise next move. Record the deepest prompt and what was independent. No physical prompting; pass and pause remain available.

Timing: Arrival 5 min, Starter 3 min, I do 5 min, We do 7 min, We do 2 5 min, Independent 8 min, Review 4 min, Exit 3 min. Total 40 minutes. Alternative route views share the same task time.

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